

OFF IN STYLE

TOURNEY IN DELHI, WITH MORE CITIES TO COME BY TEAM BT

PHOTOS BY **HARDIK CHHABRA**



IT WAS PITCH DARK, AND A CHILLY 7 DEGREES AT 7 AM ON DECEMBER 18, WHEN THE FIRST GOLFERS AMBLED IN TO REGISTER FOR THE **BUSINESS TODAY GOLF TOURNAMENT'S DELHI LEG AT THE CLASSIC GOLF & COUNTRY CLUB IN HARYANA**. BY 8 AM, TEE-OFF TIME, THE SUN HAD APPEARED, SPREADING ITS FIRST WAVES OF WELCOME WARMTH. NOT THAT THE 100 GOLFERS WHO PARTICIPATED NEEDED ANY INCENTIVE TO PLAY; THEY WERE PUMPED UP AND READY FOR ACTION.

Through the next four hours and a bit more, the golfers displayed their wares in competitive spirit as well as in camaraderie, and the return of India's most famous corporate golf tourney became as much a talking point as in earlier years.

Beginning in 1996 as a stand-alone single-city Pro-Am, **BT Golf** evolved into one of India's most-wanted golfing events for the next 22 years with top names from the world of commerce and governance, sports stars and celebrities, participating over the years.

In this 23rd edition, the draw was heavily dominated by corporate honchos, such as MG Motor India's President and MD Rajeev Chaba. "This is an event I have been looking forward to ever since it was announced," said Chaba. "It was a well-organised and well-run event, as I expected it to be."

Several sporting celebrities also graced the tourney. Madan Lal, part of the 1983 cricket World Cup winning team, former India left-arm spinner and noted commentator Murali Kartik, 1982 Asian Games gold medallist in golf and Arjuna

awardee Amit Luthra, and former India Davis Cupper Vishal Uppal represented the sporting world.

Celebrated lady golfer Simi Mehra and former India cricketer Suresh Raina were the guests of honour at the prize presentation ceremony held on the Classic course's clubhouse lawns. "It was fun out here today. This is a great game and I hope more and more people take to it. Thanks to **BT Golf** for putting together this fabulous event," said Raina.

Anju Razdan, Siddharth Sangwan and Saurabh Sood won the ladies, 0 to 14 handicap, and 15 to 24 handicap categories, respectively, in the inaugural 'Royal Ranthambore *Business Today Golf 2022-23* edition' at the Classic Golf & Country Club on Sunday.

BT Golf is presented by Royal Ranthambore. Sports and lifestyle apparel brand Nautica, Indian Oil Corporation, Rajasthan Tourism, and Titan Corporate Business Group are the other sponsors for the event. The tournament will now move to Mumbai, Bengaluru and Kolkata. **BT**

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